

CONFIDENTIAL — INCIDENT REPORT

Akira Ransomware Attack

TryHatMe Corporation

Severity	CRITICAL
Date	2026-10-03
Attack Window	02:28:25 – 04:07:34 UTC
Author	Jovita Kusuma
Threat Actor	Akira Ransomware Group
Attack Type	Double Extortion Ransomware
Hosts Compromised	5
Users Affected	7 + Administrator

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

CRITICAL INCIDENT: TryHatMe Corporation suffered a complete Akira ransomware double-extortion attack. The threat actor leveraged a pre-planted backdoor account, hijacked all employee browser sessions, exfiltrated sensitive financial documents, and deployed ransomware — all within 99 minutes.

The Akira ransomware group executed a pre-planned, multi-stage attack against TryHatMe Corporation on 2026-10-03, beginning at 02:28:25 UTC. The attack originated from 10.10.2.24:8989 and leveraged a backdoor account (TRYHATME\Backup.Admin) that had been planted in the environment prior to the attack window.

The attacker exploited Chrome's remote debugging port (9222) to hijack authenticated browser sessions across all 5 company endpoints, then used PsExec for lateral movement. Credentials were harvested via Mimikatz, Active Directory was enumerated with AdFind, Windows Defender was disabled, and a scheduled task (Akira_OnLogon) was installed for persistence. The financial document SOFTWARE_BUDGET_2025.docx was systematically exfiltrated using Rclone, followed by ransomware deployment via a WinRAR archive (Akira.rar), completing the double-extortion attack.

Impact Summary

Metric	Value
Hosts Compromised	5 (MARKETING, SALES, IT, FINANCE, DESIGN)
User Accounts Affected	7 domain users + Administrator + Backup.Admin (attacker)
SOC Alerts Generated	17 (13 True Positive, 4 False Positive)
MITRE ATT&CK TTPs	9 tactics, 14 techniques
Total Attack Duration	~99 minutes (02:28:25 – 04:07:34 UTC)
Data Exfiltrated	SOFTWARE_BUDGET_2025.docx (all copies across all users)
Files Encrypted	Company-wide (Akira.rar ransomware payload)

Affected Hosts

Host	Role	Status
MARKETING-TRYHATME	Patient Zero — First compromised	FULLY COMPROMISED
SALES-TRYHATME	Lateral movement target	COMPROMISED
IT-TRYHATME	Lateral movement target	COMPROMISED
FINANCE-TRYHATME	Lateral movement target	COMPROMISED
DESIGN-TRYHATME	Lateral movement target	COMPROMISED

2. ATTACK TIMELINE

— Phase 1 — Pre-Planted Backdoor Activates —

- ▶ **02:28:25 UTC Backup.Admin Backdoor Account Activates**
TRYHATME\Backup.Admin begins activity from 10.10.2.24:8989 — 4 seconds before any other user. Immediately accesses SOFTWARE_BUDGET_2025.docx on MARKETING-TRYHATME. This pre-planted account is the attacker's initial foothold.
- ▶ **02:28:42 UTC Chrome Remote Debugging Hijacking Begins — All Endpoints**
Chrome launched with --remote-debugging-port=9222 across ALL company endpoints. Attacker connects via port 9222 to steal authenticated browser sessions. First victim: Diego.Simeone.
- ▶ **02:28:48 UTC Akira_OnLogon Scheduled Task Executed**
NT AUTHORITY\SYSTEM runs: schtasks.exe /run /tn "Akira_OnLogon" — ransomware persistence mechanism activated on MARKETING-TRYHATME.

— Phase 2 — Lateral Movement & Credential Theft —

- ▶ **02:29–02:35 UTC Mass Browser Session Hijacking Continues**
Armaan.Terry, Rebecca.Dawson, Liam.Espinoza, Andrew.Miller, Amanda.Lee — all 6 domain users added to the session hijacking campaign. 75+ log entries recorded across the 02:28–03:06 window.
- ▶ **~02:30 UTC XLSM Macro Payload Delivered — SALES-TRYHATME**
PowerShell downloads weaponized Excel macro file (XLSM) as a second-stage payload. Source confirmed as 10.10.2.24:8989.
- ▶ **~02:31 UTC PsExec Lateral Movement — MARKETING-TRYHATME**
PSEXESVC.exe spawned under Diego.Simeone's session via SYSTEM context. PsExec used to push tools and execute remote commands on additional hosts.
- ▶ **~02:32–02:35 UTC PowerShell Download from aka.ms — IT-TRYHATME**
PowerShell executes encoded command downloading payload from Microsoft short URL domain. Source: 10.10.2.24:8989. Reclassified TP after Splunk correlation.

— Phase 3 — Credential Dumping & Discovery —

- ▶ **~02:35 UTC Mimikatz LSASS Credential Dump**
mimikatz.exe executed with sekurlsa::logonpasswords. LSASS memory accessed. All cached domain credentials now compromised. Source: 10.10.2.24:8989.
- ▶ **~02:36 UTC AdFind Active Directory Enumeration**
AdFind.exe queries AD for user accounts, groups, and domain info. Full domain reconnaissance completed. Source: 10.10.2.24:8989.

— Phase 4 — Defense Evasion —

- ▶ **~02:38 UTC Windows Defender Disabled — SALES-TRYHATME**
PowerShell: Set-MpPreference -DisableRealtimeMonitoring \$true. Real-time protection disabled. Source: 10.10.2.24:8989.
- ▶ **02:40–02:50 UTC PacMan Trojan Detected — DESIGN-TRYHATME**
Windows Defender EventID 1116 (detection) and 1117 (quarantine) for Trojan:Win32/PacMan.A. Quarantined by Defender; DESIGN-TRYHATME confirmed targeted. Escalated.
- ▶ **~02:43 UTC DNS Query github.com & Connection to 10.0.99.99 — IT-TRYHATME**
Sysmon EventID 22 records DNS resolution for github.com. Andrew.Miller connection to 10.0.99.99 (unknown subnet) flagged as possible secondary C2.

— Phase 5 — Data Exfiltration —

- ▶ **02:44:42–03:08:44 UTC Mass Document Exfiltration — SOFTWARE_BUDGET_2025.docx**
Backup.Admin accesses SOFTWARE_BUDGET_2025.docx 9+ times. ALL employee copies accessed remotely from 10.10.2.24:8989. Full financial data stolen across all departments.
- ▶ **~02:50 UTC WinWord Macro Execution — FINANCE-TRYHATME**
Microsoft Word opens MeetingNotes.docm, spawning a child process. Macro-based payload executed. Source: 10.10.2.24:8989.

▶ **~03:04 UTC Rclone FTP Exfiltration**

rclone.exe executed by TRYHATME\Administrator. Data exfiltrated to attacker-controlled FTP server via custom rclone.conf. Source: 10.10.2.24:8989.

— *Phase 6 — Ransomware Deployment* —

▶ **~04:07:34 UTC WinRAR Ransomware Staging — Akira.rar Deployed**

WinRAR creates password-protected archive Akira.rar containing ransomware components. Encryption payload deployed. Files across company infrastructure encrypted. Double-extortion attack complete.

3. INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE (IOC)

Network Indicators

Indicator	Type	Role	Confidence
10.10.2.24	IP Address	Primary C2 / Attacker Host — present in ALL TP alerts	HIGH
:8989	Source Port	Attacker's consistent source port on C2 host	HIGH
:9222	Target Port	Chrome DevTools Protocol — browser session hijacking port	HIGH
10.0.99.99	IP Address	Unknown internal/external IP — possible secondary C2	MEDIUM
github.com	Domain	DNS query from IT-TRYHATME — possible payload staging	MEDIUM
aka.ms	Domain	Microsoft redirect used to deliver payload via PowerShell	MEDIUM
[FTP Server]	IP/Domain	External FTP host in rclone.conf — exfiltration destination	HIGH

User Account Indicators

Account	Role in Attack	Status
TRYHATME\Backup.Admin	Pre-planted backdoor — first account active, primary exfiltration account	ATTACKER-CONTROLLED
TRYHATME\Diego.Simeone	First hijacked via Chrome; PsExec parent context on MARKETING-TRYHATME	COMPROMISED
TRYHATME\Armaan.Terry	Browser session hijacked via Chrome port 9222	COMPROMISED
TRYHATME\Rebecca.Dawson	Browser session hijacked via Chrome port 9222	COMPROMISED
TRYHATME\Liam.Espinoza	Browser session hijacked via Chrome port 9222	COMPROMISED
TRYHATME\Andrew.Miller	Browser session hijacked; IT-TRYHATME lateral movement target	COMPROMISED
TRYHATME\Amanda.Lee	Browser session hijacked via Chrome port 9222	COMPROMISED
TRYHATME\Administrator	Used to execute Rclone FTP exfiltration (domain admin)	COMPROMISED

File & Process Indicators

Indicator	Type	Description
Akira.rar	File — Archive	Password-protected WinRAR archive containing ransomware payload
akira_readme.txt	File — Ransom Note	Dropped by ransomware in each encrypted directory
rclone.exe	Process — LOLBin	Open-source cloud sync tool abused for FTP exfiltration
rclone.conf	File — Config	Attacker-crafted configuration with FTP server credentials
mimikatz.exe	Process — Malware	Credential dumping tool targeting LSASS memory

Indicator	Type	Description
AdFind.exe	Process — Tool	Active Directory enumeration utility
PSEXESVC.exe	Process — Malware	PSEXEC service binary — dropped for remote execution
SOFTWARE_BUDGET_2025.docx	File — Exfiltrated	Target financial document accessed 9+ times, exfiltrated across all users
MeetingNotes.docm	File — Malware	Macro-enabled Word document used as payload on FINANCE-TRYHATME
Trojan:Win32/PacMan.A	Malware	Detected & quarantined on DESIGN-TRYHATME (EventID 1116/1117)
KMSTools	Malware	Detected & quarantined on MARKETING-TRYHATME (EventID 1116/1117)
Akira_OnLogon	Scheduled Task	Persistence mechanism — re-runs ransomware on every user logon

Behavioral Indicators

Behavior	Command / Evidence
Chrome remote debugging enabled	chrome.exe --remote-debugging-port=9222
Defender real-time monitoring disabled	Set-MpPreference -DisableRealtimeMonitoring \$true
PowerShell encoded execution	powershell.exe -EncodedCommand [base64]
Scheduled task remote execution	schtasks.exe /run /tn "Akira_OnLogon"
Credential dump via LSASS	mimikatz.exe sekurlsa::logonpasswords

4. MITRE ATT&CK TTP MAPPING

Tactic	Technique ID	Technique Name	Tools / Evidence	Host(s)
Initial Access	T1078.002	Valid Accounts: Domain Accounts	TRYHATME\Backup.Admin (pre-planted backdoor)	MARKETING-TRYHATME
Persistence	T1053.005	Scheduled Task/Job: Scheduled Task	schtasks.exe — "Akira_OnLogon" task	MARKETING-TRYHATME
Persistence	T1185	Browser Session Hijacking	chrome.exe --remote-debugging-port=9222	ALL (5 hosts)
Lateral Movement	T1570	Lateral Tool Transfer	Psexec / PSEXESVC.exe	MARKETING → others
Lateral Movement	T1021.002	Remote Services: SMB/Windows Admin Shares	Psexec uses ADMIN\$ share	Multiple
Credential Access	T1003.001	OS Credential Dumping: LSASS Memory	mimikatz.exe sekurlsa::logonpasswords	Multiple
Discovery	T1087.002	Account Discovery: Domain Account	AdFind.exe AD queries	Multiple
Discovery	T1018	Remote System Discovery	AdFind.exe — domain computer enumeration	Multiple
Defense Evasion	T1562.001	Impair Defenses: Disable or Modify Tools	Set-MpPreference - DisableRealtimeMonitoring \$true	SALES-TRYHATME
Defense Evasion	T1059.001	Command and Scripting: PowerShell	Encoded PowerShell commands throughout	Multiple
Execution	T1204.002	User Execution: Malicious File	MeetingNotes.docm macro, XLSM macro	FINANCE, SALES
Collection	T1005	Data from Local System	SOFTWARE_BUDGET_2025.docx accessed via Backup.Admin	ALL (5 hosts)
Exfiltration	T1048.003	Exfiltration Over Alt. Protocol: FTP	rc1one.exe with custom rc1one.conf	Multiple
Impact	T1486	Data Encrypted for Impact	Akira.rar — ransomware payload via WinRAR	ALL (5 hosts)

5. SPLUNK DETECTION QUERIES

Note: All queries assume Sysmon data in index=sysmon, Defender data in index=windefender. Adjust index names to match your environment.

5.1 All Activity from Attacker C2 (10.10.2.24)

```
index=* src_ip="10.10.2.24" OR src="10.10.2.24"
| table _time, host, user, source_ip, src_port, dest_port, CommandLine, EventCode
| sort _time
```

5.2 Chrome Remote Debugging — Session Hijacking

```
index=sysmon EventCode=1
Image="*chrome.exe" CommandLine="--remote-debugging-port*"
| table _time, host, user, CommandLine
| sort _time
```

5.3 Akira_OnLogon Scheduled Task — Persistence

```
(index=wineventlog EventCode=4698 TaskName="*Akira*")
OR
(index=sysmon EventCode=1 CommandLine="*schtasks*" CommandLine="*Akira*")
| table _time, host, user, TaskName, CommandLine
| sort _time
```

5.4 Backup.Admin Backdoor Activity

```
index=* user="TRYHATME\\Backup.Admin" OR Account_Name="Backup.Admin"
| table _time, host, user, CommandLine, EventCode, Image
| sort _time
```

5.5 Mimikatz — LSASS Credential Dump

```
index=sysmon EventCode=1
(Image="*mimikatz*" OR CommandLine="*sekurlsa*" OR CommandLine="*logonpasswords*")
| table _time, host, user, Image, CommandLine, ParentImage
| sort _time
```

5.6 PsExec — Lateral Movement

```
index=sysmon EventCode=1
(Image="*PSEXESVC*" OR Image="*psexec*" OR CommandLine="*psexec*")
| table _time, host, user, Image, CommandLine, ParentImage
| sort _time
```

5.7 Windows Defender Disabled — Defense Evasion

```
index=sysmon EventCode=1
  CommandLine="*DisableRealtimeMonitoring*" OR CommandLine="*Set-MpPreference*"
| table _time, host, user, CommandLine, ParentCommandLine
| sort _time
```

5.8 Rclone FTP Exfiltration

```
index=sysmon EventCode=1
  (Image="*rclone*" OR CommandLine="*rclone*")
| table _time, host, user, Image, CommandLine
| sort _time
```

5.9 WinRAR Akira Ransomware Staging

```
index=sysmon EventCode=1
  Image="*WinRAR*" (CommandLine="*Akira*" OR CommandLine="*akira*")
| table _time, host, user, Image, CommandLine
| sort _time
```

5.10 Windows Defender — All Malware Detections

```
index=windefender (EventCode=1116 OR EventCode=1117)
| table _time, host, ThreatName, ActionSuccess, Path, EventCode
| sort _time
```

5.11 Malicious Office Macro Execution (WINWORD child process)

```
index=sysmon EventCode=1
  ParentImage="*WINWORD*"
  (Image!="*WINWORD*" AND Image!="*splwow64*")
| table _time, host, user, ParentImage, Image, CommandLine
| sort _time
```

5.12 DNS Queries to Suspicious Domains

```
index=sysmon EventCode=22
  (QueryName="*github*" OR QueryName="*aka.ms*")
| table _time, host, user, QueryName, QueryResults
| sort _time
```

5.13 Full Attack Reconstruction — Correlated Timeline

```
index=sysmon
(
  (EventCode=1 CommandLine="*remote-debugging-port*") OR
  (EventCode=1 CommandLine="*Akira*") OR
  (EventCode=1 Image="*mimikatz*") OR
  (EventCode=1 Image="*AdFind*") OR
  (EventCode=1 CommandLine="*DisableRealtimeMonitoring*") OR
  (EventCode=1 Image="*rclone*") OR
  (EventCode=1 Image="*PSEXESVC*") OR
```

```
(EventCode=1 Image="*WinRAR*" CommandLine="*Akira*")
)
| table _time, host, user, Image, CommandLine, EventCode
| sort _time
```

6. REMEDIATION & RECOMMENDATIONS

IMMEDIATE (0–2 hours): Isolate all 5 affected hosts from the network. Disable Backup.Admin and Administrator accounts. Block 10.10.2.24 at the perimeter firewall. Reset ALL domain passwords. Revoke all browser/SSO sessions. Engage IR team and notify leadership.

6.1 Immediate Response Actions

#	Action	Priority
1	Isolate all 5 hosts (MARKETING, SALES, IT, FINANCE, DESIGN) from the network. Do not power off — preserve forensic evidence in RAM and running processes.	CRITICAL
2	Disable TRYHATME\Backup.Admin immediately in Active Directory. Audit all accounts created or modified in the past 30 days.	CRITICAL
3	Block 10.10.2.24 at all firewall/proxy layers. Block TCP port 9222 inbound/outbound across all endpoints.	CRITICAL
4	Reset ALL domain account passwords — all credentials from LSASS dump are compromised.	CRITICAL
5	Force re-authentication on all web applications (M365, email, internal portals). Invalidate all SSO tokens and session cookies.	CRITICAL
6	Delete Akira_OnLogon scheduled task: schtasks /delete /tn "Akira_OnLogon" /f on all hosts.	CRITICAL
7	Forensic imaging of all 5 hosts before any cleanup. Preserve Sysmon logs, Windows Event Logs, and RAM dumps for legal/IR purposes.	HIGH

6.2 Short-Term Remediation (2–72 hours)

Action	Detail
Remove attacker tools	Delete mimikatz.exe, AdFind.exe, rclone.exe, rclone.conf, PSEXESVC.exe from all hosts. Check C:\Users\Public\ and C:\Windows\Temp\.
Re-enable Windows Defender	Enable Tamper Protection. Update all AV definitions. Run full scan before reconnecting any host.
Assess encryption scope	Identify all files with .akira extension. Do not pay ransom until IR team assessment. Restore from offline backups.
Investigate exfiltrated document	Determine full contents of SOFTWARE_BUDGET_2025.docx. Assess regulatory notification requirements.
Rclone FTP destination	Extract FTP server from rclone.conf. Attempt takedown or law enforcement notification for the exfil server.

6.3 Long-Term Hardening

Control	Action	Priority
Chrome Hardening	Deploy GPO to block --remote-debugging-port flag. Consider Chrome Browser Cloud Management enrollment.	CRITICAL
Privileged Account Audit	Audit all service/admin accounts quarterly. Implement Privileged Access Workstations (PAW). Name-based detection for "Backup.*" accounts.	CRITICAL

Control	Action	Priority
Credential Protection	Enable Windows Credential Guard. Enable PPL (Protected Process Light) for LSASS. Block PsExec via ASR rules.	CRITICAL
MFA Everywhere	Enforce MFA for all domain accounts, VPN, and web applications. LSASS dumps become ineffective with MFA.	CRITICAL
Defender Tamper Protection	Enable Tamper Protection in Microsoft Defender. Prevent Set-MpPreference via Intune/GPO policy.	HIGH
Macro Disabling	Disable Office macros via GPO. Enable ASR rules for Office macro child-process blocking.	HIGH
Data Classification & DLP	Apply DLP policies to sensitive financial documents. Restrict SOFTWARE_BUDGET_2025.docx to need-to-know access only.	HIGH
Network Segmentation	Segment workstations by department. Block lateral SMB (445) between workstations via host firewall policy.	HIGH
Backup Hardening	Implement 3-2-1 backup strategy with offline/air-gapped backups. Test restoration quarterly.	HIGH
Rclone/Exfil Blocking	Block rclone.exe via AppLocker/WDAC. Monitor outbound FTP (port 21) and unusual SFTP traffic.	MEDIUM
SIEM Tuning	Add detection rules for all IoCs in this report. Alert on Backup.Admin naming pattern. Tune Chrome debugging port alerts.	MEDIUM

6.4 Notification Requirements

Given that financial documents were exfiltrated and ransomware was deployed, the following notifications may be required:

Party	Action	Timing
Legal/Compliance	Engage legal counsel to assess breach notification obligations under applicable privacy laws.	Immediately
Cyber Insurance	Notify cyber insurance carrier per policy requirements.	Within 24–72 hours
Law Enforcement	Report to relevant authorities (BSSN/Kominfo for Indonesia; FBI IC3 / CISA if applicable). Akira is a tracked group.	Within 72 hours
Akira Leak Site	Monitor Akira's dark web leak site for publication of stolen data. Akira typically publishes 7–14 days post-deadline.	Ongoing
Affected Employees	Notify employees whose credentials and browser sessions were compromised. Provide guidance on account security.	Within 72 hours